Cowabunga SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

SUN OCT 18, 2026 DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · SUN OCT 18 · NORTH PB

The 17-second swell is here. Little Point early, before the NW wind.

new SSW groundswell, light E early:
paddle out by 7:00

PADDLE OUT BY	7:00	BOARD Inferno 72 ~73°F WATER

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	7–10:30a · Inferno 72 · ~73°F
SURF	3–5 ft (SRF), long lulls at 17s
TIDE	H 3.6 @ 7:16a L 3.5 @ 9:40a H 4.1 @ 3:13p L 0.8 @ 11:25p obs 4.8 @ 5:36a

Long period, long lulls.

8 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Very good — move a meeting

capped by swell 3.8 ft · Better than 83% of 35 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3-5 FT (SRF), LONG LULLS AT 17S

GROUND

SwH 3.3–4.9 ft · 17s

WINDSWELL

WWH 1.0 ft · 10s

HS BUOY

Hs 3.6 ft · 46258



FROM

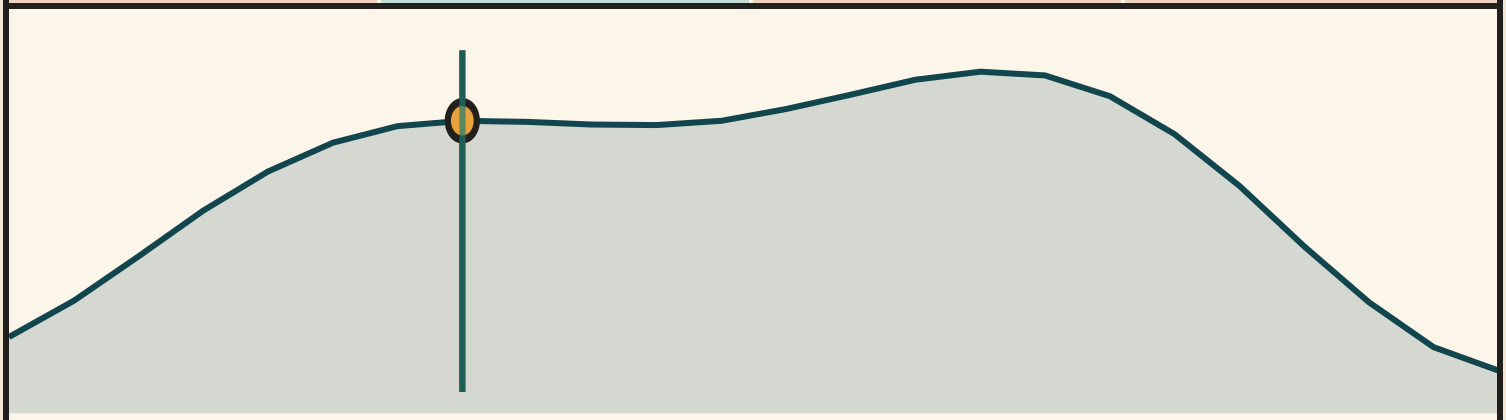
195° SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 3.6 ft @ 17s SSW (spectrum SwH 3.3–4.9 ft @ 17–18s overnight) + WWH 1.0 ft @ 10s · face 3–5 ft (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 SW 4 ft @ 16s + NW 1 ft @ 15s · MWD 195° SSW · wind light E early, NW 10 mph from 1p

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

PRE-7A · FIRST LIGHT	7–10:30A · LITTLE POINT	10:30A–1P · LIGHT W	1–6P · NW 10 MPH + CEILING
WAIT	GO	MEH	SKIP



7:00a	GO · Little Point	3.6 ft tide	E ~4 kt · NWS	3–5 ft (SRF), long lulls at 17s

H 3.6 @ 7:16a · L 3.5 @ 9:40a · H 4.1 @ 3:13p · L 0.8 @ 11:25p · obs 4.8 @ 5:36a

Little Point, 7 to about 10:30a, on the Inferno 72. The tide barely moves this morning: H 3.6 @ 7:16a, a tiny dip to L 3.5 @ 9:40a, then up to H 4.1 @ 3:13p. The gauge read 4.81 ft at 5:36a against 3.48 predicted, about 1.3 ft over the table, so the reef holds near 4.9 ft all morning and only nears the 5.5 ft ceiling around 2 to 4p. LJAC1 read ESE 3 kt at 5a. NWS hourly has E 5 mph through 8a, SE at 9a, SW 5 mph at 10a, W 5 mph 11a to noon, then NW 10 mph from 1p (PZZ740 variable under 10 kt becoming NW 10 kt this afternoon). The first light-offshore hours are the cleanest. Sunrise 6:55a, sunset 6:14p.

Where it's working

★

Little Point

Top of the scorecard at 0.98. The new SSW groundswell is in at 17 seconds (46258 Hs 3.6 ft @ 17s, MWD 195° at 5:26a; spectrum SwH 3.3–4.9 ft @ 16.7–18.2s overnight). The tide is nearly flat all morning (H 3.6 @ 7:16a, L 3.5 @ 9:40a), and the gauge is running about 1.3 ft over the table (4.81 ft at 5:36a vs 3.48 predicted), so the reef sits near 4.9 ft, right in its 3.0–5.5 ft band. Light E through 8a, then the wind swings SE and SW. Paddle out by 7:00.

CALL

2

Calumet

Score 0.81. Great swell angle, but flagged tide-high vs its lower window with the gauge this full. Pass.

SOFT

3

PB Drive

Score 0.72. Flagged long-period closeout risk: 17-second SSW tends to wall up on the sandbar. Only if the reef is packed; bring the Anvil.

SOFT

4

Tourmaline

Score 0.71. Too full on a gauge near 5 ft.

SOFT

5

PB north of the pier

Score 0.69. SSW mostly misses the pier wedge; the NW 1 ft @ 15s in PZZ740 is too small to help.

SOFT

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Skip · PB Point (0.54) is too full on the high gauge. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) and OB want W groundswell and lower tide; today is SSW on a full, flat tide. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) will show bigger sets on 17 seconds, but the high gauge softens them and Sunday crowds pile in, so they do not beat a clean local reef.

SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~73°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Long-period groundswell on a steep reef with light offshore early. Punchy, clean Inferno territory at Little Point.

Anvil twin · if you end up on the Drive sandbar
TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Long period, long lulls.

Seventeen-second swell travels in groups. The buoy jumped from 3.3 to 4.9 ft between readings overnight because it caught a set, not because the swell doubled. At the reef that means five quiet minutes and then three waves that are bigger than they looked from the stairs. Sit a full set cycle before you paddle out, and pick your spot on the set, not the lull.

SKIP

The afternoon: NW 10 mph from 1p and a gauge-adjusted tide near the 5.5 ft ceiling around 2 to 4p. PB Drive on 17-second closeouts. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on a gauge this full. The Cliffs and OB on a SSW primary swell.

GOTCHAS

Seventeen-second sets mean long lulls, then a solid set that stacks on the shallow ledge, so wait a full set cycle before you paddle out. It is Sunday on the best swell of the week, so Little Point and Windansea will crowd fast. High rip current risk today (NWS SRF). Hot and sunny again, near 78°F by noon, so bring water for the stairs at Fern Glen.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL: Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES